

HRRP BULLETIN

3 September 2018



Ward No. 3, Rupa Rural Municipality, Kaski: this hollow concrete block house has been found to be non-compliant as the household has not followed one of the approved type designs and there are no general standards for hollow concrete block construction.



Ward No. 28, Pokhara Lekhnath Metropolitan City, Kaski: this hollow concrete block house has been found to be non-compliant as the household has not followed one of the approved type designs and there are no general standards for hollow concrete block construction.

Highlights

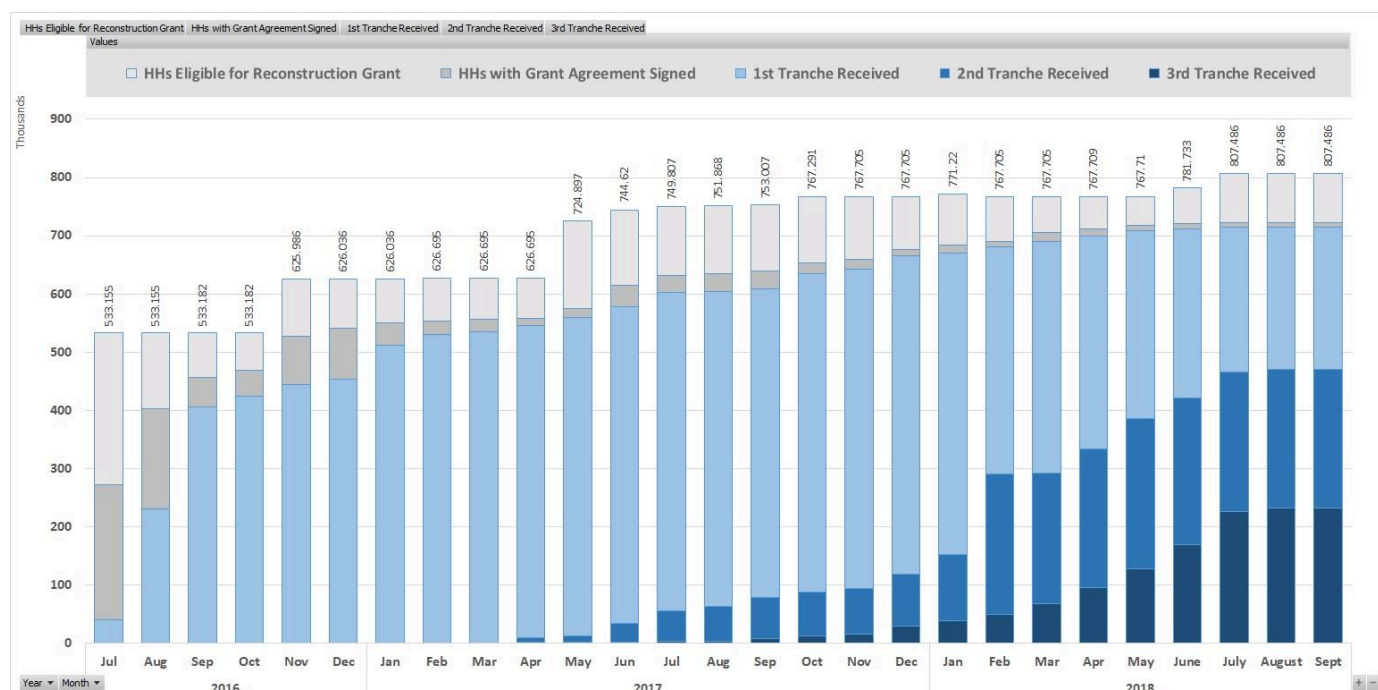
- HRRP advocates for the tranche disbursement deadlines to be extended for at least the next two building seasons in rural areas, and the next four in urban areas, to allow a realistic period for households to complete their reconstruction.
 - [NRA, Building DLPIU Technical Staff Survey Report](#)
 - Joint Field Visits, Orientations, and Action Planning for 18 Moderately Affected Districts: the NRA, along with the Building and GMALI CLPIUs and HRRP, have jointly organised field visits and interaction sessions with municipal officials and NRA, Building DLPIU technical staff in the 18 moderately affected districts during the next two weeks.
 - Initial results from the HRRP [Partner Satisfaction Survey](#) – many thanks to the 230 people that took the time to respond!
 - [5W Database](#) as of 25 August 2018
 - Request for Partner Organisation support for Lalitpur GMALI DLPIU survey to identify issues faced by households that have yet to sign the Partnership Agreement with the government
 - Request for Partner Organisation support 'Interaction and Reconstruction Strategic Action Planning Sessions' with Municipalities in 14 Districts
 - [Common Feedback Project, Community Perception Report, Reconstruction, Food Security, and Livelihoods and Protection, August 2018](#)
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UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

[NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 3 September:](#)

	1 August	19 August	3 September
Total No. Eligible HHs	807,486	807,486	807,486
HHs Enrolled	722,101	722,174	722,174
HHs Received 1st Tranche	714,174	714,401	714,401
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	502,742	510,884	516,524
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	468,516	470,861	470,861
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	271,895	283,294	296,743
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	226,791	231,670	231,670



Housing reconstruction progress based on MoFALD CLPIU enrolment data from July 2016 to 3 September 2018.

HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey, Initial Results: many thanks to the 230 people who participated; 84% of responses were from people based at district level and 16% were from people based at national level. A full report will be shared soon, but some initial findings are as follows:

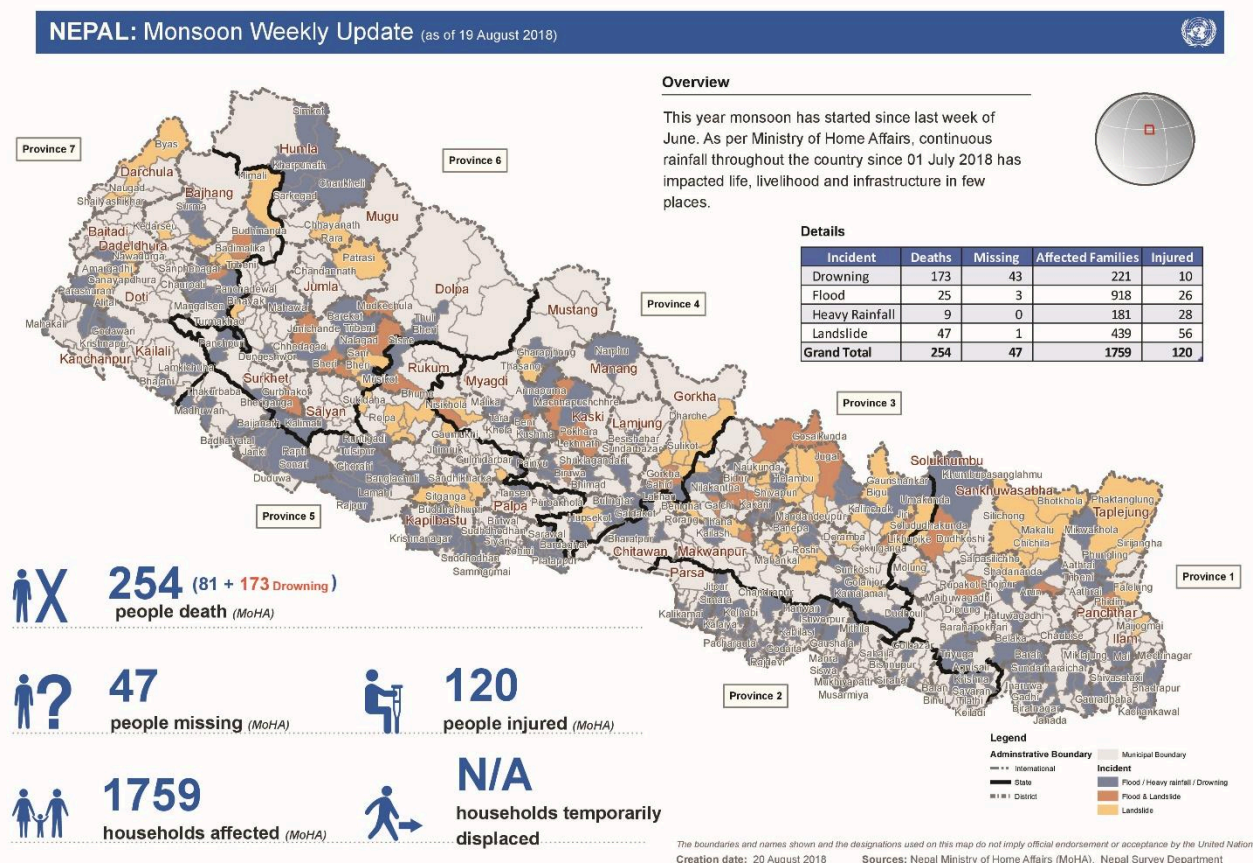
- 98.7% of respondents read the HRRP bulletin (an increase from 97.3% in the previous round). Of those that read the bulletin, 31% find it very useful (same as previous round), 56% find it useful (increase of 6% from previous round), and 11% find it somewhat useful (decrease of 5% from previous round).
- 61% of respondents reported that their organisation had made changes to activities or programmes based on information shared and / or discussions at HRRP district level events (meetings, orientations, trainings, or workshops).
- 99% of respondents (9% increase from previous round) agree that HRRP technical information and guidance is easy to access, 86% agree that it is well researched (5% increase from previous round), and 96% agree that it is relevant to their work (2% increase from previous round).
- 82% of respondents (10% increase from previous round) agree that HRRP has reduced gaps and prevented duplication in reconstruction efforts. 13% remained neutral and 4% disagreed with the statement.

- 60% of respondents (1% decrease from previous round) agree that HRRP has supported strengthening of emergency preparedness and response. 32% remained neutral and 8% disagreed (4% decrease from previous round) with the statement.
- 44% of respondents agree that HRRP has promoted and mainstreamed Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) in reconstruction work. 33% remained neutral and 22% disagreed with the statement. This result shows that HRRP has opportunity and space to promote GESI in reconstruction work.

The previous rounds of satisfaction survey results are available here: [first round results](#), [second round results](#).

Second Tranche Disbursement Deadline, 16 July: it has been almost one year since the NRA first announced the tranche disbursement deadlines ([see HRRP Bulletin from 24 July 2017](#)) and there has been mounting evidence that the deadline is causing trauma and stress for people trying to manage their housing reconstruction. The deadlines are part of the reason for the [large-scale borrowing at high interest rates that look set to cause a potential debt crisis](#). They are also the reason for people building small houses just to collect the grant. These houses do not meet people's living requirements and cannot represent a successful housing reconstruction. It is very positive that the numbers of households progressing with their construction is consistently increasing, but as of 1 August there are 580,695 households that need support to get to completion. This is not possible within the current deadlines. Experience from other post-disaster reconstruction efforts shows that approximately 5 years is required at least, and urban requires more time. **HRRP advocates for the deadlines to be extended for at least the next two building seasons in rural areas, and the next four in urban areas, to allow a realistic period for households to complete their reconstruction.**

Monsoon Impact: heavy rainfall since the beginning of July has caused loss of life and damage to property and infrastructure in many areas of Nepal. The infographic below from the UN RCO, provides a summary of the situation as of [19 August](#).



Districts & Municipalities

Joint Field Visits, Orientations, and Action Planning for 18 Moderately Affected Districts: the NRA, along with the Building and GMALI CLPIUs and HRRP, have jointly organised field visits and interaction sessions with all stakeholders in the 18 moderately affected districts. The sessions will provide an opportunity to discuss and analyse the progress so far, challenges, issues, and the way forward to support effective and successful reconstruction. During the visits, GMALI DLPIU with support from HRRP will be conducting a detailed survey with all municipalities. The survey form is available in [English and Nepali](#). In addition to this a one day orientation and interaction workshop will be the GMALI DLPIUs with support from HRRP where all municipal officials will be briefed on the reconstruction process and policies and each municipality will develop and endorse a [municipal strategic action plan for the reconstruction](#). In parallel, the Building DLPIUs, with support from HRRP, will hold one day technical orientations and interaction programmes with all NRA, Building DLPIU technical staff to orient them on the technical processes and guidelines and to have a detailed interaction on non-compliance issues. The session will also be an opportunity to share experience and learning from other districts.

District	Municipal orientation & interaction programme	Technical orientation
Chitwan	4 September	5 September
Nawalparasi (Nawalpur and Parasi)	10 September	11 September
Kaski	4 September	5 September
Syangja	10 September	11 September
Lamjung	4 September	5 September
Tanahun	10 September	11 September
Solukhumbu	4 September	5 September
Khotang	10 September	11 September
Arghakhachi	4 September	5 September
Gulmi	9 September	10 September
Palpa	12 September	13 September
Baglung	4 September	5 September
Myagdi	10 September	11 September
Parbat	13 September	14 September
Dhankuta	5 September	6 September
Sankhuwasabha	10 September	11 September
Bhojpur	16 September	17 September

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 17 – 31 August: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Lalitpur (20 August), Kathmandu (21 August), Sindhupalchok (22 August), Gorkha (23 August), Kavrepalanchok (23 August), Dolakha (24 August), Dhading (28 August), Nuwakot (29 August), and Ramechhap (29 August). Municipal level meetings took place in Barhabise Municipality, Sindhupalchok (17 August), Panchkhal, Kavrepalanchok (17 August), Indrasarobar Rural Municipality, Makwanpur (20-22 August), and Sunapati Rural Municipality (24-25 August). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Lalitpur**, all POs working in the district shared their progress and were requested to submit the monthly report by email before the coordination meeting and to provide hard copies during the meeting.
- In **Kathmandu**, the main issues highlighted are lack of land ownership papers, small parcels of land, and eccentric footings. POs were requested to give verbal and written requests with data evidence in order to address the unsolved issues of reconstruction in their working areas. DCC Kathmandu office is ready to contribute to reconstruction processes by coordinating with municipalities on addressing the issues, gaps and challenges of reconstruction. DCC Kathmandu and NRA, GMALI DLPIU Kathmandu has decided to conduct monitoring visits to observe reconstruction efforts taken by Lumanti in Machhegaun, Chandragiri Municipality on 3rd September 2018.

- In **Sindhupalchok**, discussion covered the need for resurvey in all Rural Municipalities and concerns about need of large room sizes to construct houses in traditional “Hyolmo” design. The technical staff reported facing challenges as the “Hyolmo” design is not covered in the DUDBC design catalogues. However, structural analysis has been done for the “Hyolmo” design and now clear standards are needed. In some municipalities, e.g. Helambu, many houses that have used timber bands are facing problems due to warping of the bands because the timber has not been properly treated before use and legal issues associated in acquiring good quality timber. Technical staff also reported facing difficulties with retrofitting, especially for stone and mud mortar masonry houses. There was also discussion about households that own less than 2 aanas of land which is not enough to build a house. Regarding the resettlement of displaced households there are not enough land surveyors from the District Land Survey Department to cover the work. It was suggested that an additional land surveyor be placed in NRA, GMaLI DLPIU to speed up the resettlement process.
- In **Gorkha**, NRA, GMaLI DLPIU requested all POs to focus on retrofitting and relocation. GMaLI DLPIU informed that households that wish to register a complaint about not being included in grievances can do so through the mechanism set up at central level. Once the result is published, the Government will not entertain any further appeals. **It was noted that the non-compliance issues have been reduced from 28% to 5%, with technical assistance from all stakeholders.** Relocation issues should be solved based on Government land ownership guideline. Landless households will have to oriented according to the guideline as well. The process of distributing construction completion certificate and involvement of DLPIU, POs and local government was also discussed. Furthermore, identifying and analysing the gap in support to vulnerable households will be done in close coordination with local bodies and POs.
- In **Kavrepalanchok**, NRA is working on classifying the retrofit beneficiaries in more detail following many grievances on retrofitting mechanism mostly for stone and mud mortar houses. There is need of coordination with NRA MIS to release the tranches of beneficiaries who have been converted from retrofit beneficiaries to reconstruction beneficiaries. The MIS still recognises them as retrofit beneficiaries. Recently identified beneficiaries from resurvey and reverification have been categorised as per the new local structure whereas the earlier ones were as per the old structure. This may cause problems in data entry and indexing both at GMaLI DLPIU and Building DLPIU. **Building DLPIU has updated the contact details of technical staff and will place one Engineer at GMaLI to communicate the errors and tranche updates to technical staff and for better coordination between GMaLI and Building DLPIUs.** There is need to tally tranche figures at VDC level since there still is a GMaLI and DUDBC.
- In **Dolakha**, 9,899 HHs (14%) have not signed the PA. The GMaLI DLPIU Chief requested all stakeholders to work collectively to reduce this figure and increase the number of households that have received the tranches. Issues with the quality of mason training, especially training delivered by private firms, were discussed and all agreed to improve the selection process, to maintain the training database, and to coordinate with the GMaLI, Building, and Education DLPIUs before conducting any mason training. During the meeting it was agreed to maintain data on the number of houses constructed at ward level and to monitor the quality of interlocking bricks and hollow concrete blocks.
- In **Dhading**, the concept of “Rural/Urban Municipality Revolving Fund” implemented in Gorkha was shared and was considered an effective way to support vulnerable households. The District Administrative Office requested all actors to coordinate with and support Rural/Urban Municipalities to establish such revolving funds. POs were requested to provide volunteer geologists to support identification of hazard prone areas within the district. DCC requested all POs and Government authorities to work together in close coordination to establish Dhading as a model district. A joint monitoring field visit with DAO, DCC, DLPIU, GMaLI and relevant stakeholders is to be organised by POs.
- In **Nuwakot**, urban housing reconstruction issues were discussed in relation to old and new urban municipalities. In Ward No. 9 of Bidur Municipality, despite some households having completed construction, no completion certificates have been distributed. The ward chairperson informed that there are 14 households eligible for the retrofit grant in the ward but none have received the second (and final) tranche. The Building DLPIU technical staff have informed that they cannot disburse the second tranche as they do not have the retrofit inspection form. **The ward chairperson also informed that approximately 60% of households have constructed a one room, one storey building just to access the housing**

reconstruction grant while they continue to live in another building which is non-compliant / pre-earthquake structure that did not collapse. The ward chairperson requested support for vulnerable households who have not yet started rebuilding due to lack of money and support.

- In **Ramechhap**, partner organisations provided progress updates; CDS with support from MCC is supporting livelihoods for the Majhi community in Manthali, HELVETAS/SW is providing technical assistance, and 1,232 out of total 1,296 households have completed reconstruction in Bijulikot of Likhu Tamakoshi Rural Municipality supported by MEDAIR.
- In **Barhabise, Sindhupalchok**, Building DLPIU technical staff are not equipped with tablets and printers so they rely on their own mobile for photos and print them by themselves. Some of locations (e.g. Dandakhet, Maneswara) are hard for the technical staff to reach and can take 4-5 hours of walking. The awareness amongst households of the reconstruction process is low in those areas due to low presence of technical people. The ward representatives have recognised the need to address these issues. The banks operating in the district have not been able to provide adequate services to the households and at times people have had to walk for days to receive the tranche but return empty handed. There is lack of clarity in the guidelines for resettlement of displaced households. **The construction of one room, one storey houses continues to increase in prevalence. Some beneficiaries continue to live in their damaged houses after repair and have constructed one room house just to obtain the Government reconstruction grant.** There is a shortage of skilled masons though there have been quite a few trainings. People also requested for carpenter training in addition to mason training.
- In **Panchkhal, Kavre**, all the ward representatives advocated for wards to have the authority to provide permits for two and four room structures in either stone or brick masonry. The policy permitting the construction in Guthi Land increased the construction rate in Ward No. 9 and in Ward No. 12 the permits to construct adobe structures has increased the reconstruction rate. Each ward is working to collect details of houses yet to reconstruct and of vulnerable households. The most common challenges reported were: banking issues and delay in tranche disbursement, retrofitting challenges and need to convert retrofit beneficiaries to full 300,000 NPRs reconstruction beneficiaries, and addressing the non-compliant houses constructed immediately after the earthquake. The issue of real beneficiaries being missed in the resurvey and reverification list and the need to ease the process to support the landless in reconstruction were also discussed during the meeting.
- In **Wards 1 – 5, Indrasarobar RM, Makwanpur**, it was agreed that ward offices will publish public notices such as radio messages urging households that have not done so yet to sign the PA and urging households that have received the first tranche to start reconstruction. It was also agreed to identify why households have not signed the PA / not started reconstruction and inform GMAI. For the beneficiaries who have signed PA but still not being able to receive the tranches due to discrepancy in their names in different documents, the ward office has agreed to verify such beneficiaries and send the list to GMAI for further action. The ward office has agreed to support the PA signing process of the beneficiaries added from resurvey/reverification, grievances list. The ward offices will complete the verification of households on the vulnerable list and send it to GMAI and will also work on the identification and further process for landless beneficiaries. Further, the meeting agreed to ensure effective communication and dissemination of information related to tranches and other issues.
- In **Sunapati RM, Ramechhap**, the reconstruction is progressing at a good pace in the area. However, there are concerns regarding retrofitting and many retrofit beneficiaries want to move to the 300,000 NPRs reconstruction grant. Although, many new houses have been constructed, people are still living in the old ones. Local representatives should motivate the beneficiaries to live in the new houses. Few non-earthquake beneficiaries have constructed houses not following the Government building code. Such people should also be given information to build houses according to Government building code. **It was reported that some beneficiaries are providing one bay roofing without any fixed connection to the wall with the intention of expanding the house after receiving all three Government tranches.** Some damaged houses of the area have not been listed as beneficiaries even after the resurvey and reverification. There are houses built providing expansion gap on DPC and using the same roof. Beneficiaries are requesting to consider these houses as two.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Weekly District Report, 17 – 30 August 2018



Ward No. 7, Melung Rural Municipality, Dolakha: stone and cement mortar masonry house. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and has been approved for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 17 – 30 August 2018



Ward No.3, Chumsubri Rural Municipality, Gorkha: a one room, stone masonry and gabion wire house. The house has been constructed with support from Samaritan's Purse. Samaritan's Purse is supporting construction of 50 houses in Chumsubri Rural Municipality.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Valley, Weekly District Report, 17 – 30 August 2018



Ward No. 8, Dakshinkalii Municipality, Kathmandu: one storey load bearing structure. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and has requested inspection for the third tranche. However, the house is missing roof band. The beneficiary has agreed to add the roof band after which the third tranche will be approved.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Weekly District Report, 17 – 30 August 2018



Ward No. 4, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: a hybrid structure with ground floor constructed from brick and cement mortar masonry and the first floor is a prefabricated structure. The owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Ramechhap, Weekly District Report, 17 – 30 August 2018



Ward No. 6, Sunapati Rural Municipality, Ramechhap: one storey, three room house, constructed using interlocking blocks. The owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Weekly District Report, 17 – 30 August 2018



Ward No. 3, Barhabise Municipality, Sindhupalchok: one storey, two room house, load bearing structure constructed from brick and cement mortar masonry. The owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

Requests for Partner Support

Request for Partner Organisation Support for GMALI DLPIU, Lalitpur Survey: there are nearly 4,000 households in Lalitpur that are eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant but have yet to sign the Partnership Agreement with the government. In order to understand the factors that are influencing this, the GMALI DLPIU in the district are planning a survey of all these households to document the issues and challenges they face and to develop effective ways to address these. The GMALI DLPIU is requesting Partner Organisations to support this initiative, particularly by providing enumerators to carry out the surveys. POs that are interested to support should contact Sweata Sijapati, HRRP District Technical Coordinator Kathmandu Valley, techcord.ktm@hrrpnepal.org.

Interaction and Reconstruction Strategic Action Planning Sessions with Municipalities in 14 Districts: the GMALI DLPIUs in the 14 most affected districts, with support from HRRP, will be conducting interaction programmes in the coming weeks where the [detailed municipal survey](#) will be filled in (as in the 18 districts, see above) and each municipality will develop and endorse a [municipal strategic action plan for the reconstruction](#). Partner Organisations interested to support with these sessions are requested to contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP National Coordination Officer, minar@hrrpnepal.org.

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

HRRP

NRA, Building DLPIU Technical Staff Survey Report: this survey was designed to understand how Building DLPIU technical staff access information and how they share it with households, how to better support information sharing to technical staff and from technical staff to households, to gather more information on the experience of Building DLPIU technical staff and to increase focus on them and the important role they play in the reconstruction, and to provide space for Building DLPIU technical staff to share what support they feel they need. Some immediate actions that are suggested considering the survey findings are as follows:

- Address transportation issues
- Add sections specifically for the Building DLPIU technical staff to the NRA (<http://nra.gov.np/np>) and MoUD CLPIU (<http://moudclpiu.gov.np/>) websites. The new municipal websites could also have sections dedicated to the technical staff.
- Development of the EHRP mobile application for all 32 earthquake affected districts as a tool to provide access to detailed updates on tranche disbursement based on each households PA number.
- Include social mobilisers as part of the Building DLPIU technical teams to support communication and engagement with households and communities
- Increase training and sharing opportunities for technical staff – both for reconstruction as well as looking to the long term
- Set up a backstopping system with senior engineers and social mobilisers available as roving support, focused on guidance and mentoring for Building DLPIU technical staff
- Facilitate regular coordination meetings between Building DLPIU, GMALI DLPIU, municipal officials, ward technicians, and Building DLPIU technical staff

5W Database: as of 25 August 2018.

Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps: based on Building CLPIU inspection data as of 22 August.

[Partnership Agreement between HHs and GoN](#)

[Construction Started](#)

[1st tranche received](#)

[Compliance rate 2nd tranche](#)

[Compliance rate 3rd tranche](#)

[Construction Completed](#)

Municipal Revolving Fund, Note on Experience in Aarughat, Gorkha: this note describes the experience to date in Aarughat Rural Municipality, Gorkha of establishing and managing a municipal revolving fund. The objective of the fund is to support vulnerable households to get through construction of the foundation of their house and to receive the second tranche of the Government of Nepal (GoN) housing reconstruction grant. Households that receive funds from the revolving fund must return the money they took once they receive the second tranche from the GoN and this money is then available for another household. To date, 30 households in Aarughat have taken support from the revolving fund and 20 of these have already repaid the amount they took. Three other municipalities in Gorkha are also preparing to establish a revolving fund.

Partners

Common Feedback Project, Community Perception Report, Reconstruction, Food Security, and Livelihoods and Protection, August 2018: this report reflects the results of 2580 household surveys, conducted between July 24 and August 5, with earthquake affected households across 40 municipalities in 16 affected districts. On a positive note, 63% of respondents reported feeling more able to cope with future disasters now than they were before the earthquake. For the most part, they attribute that improved sense of resilience to believing they have an earthquake safe home, having a preparedness plan, and having safe storage for food, grains and assets. This is an encouraging finding for the reconstruction and recovery programme, which has at its core the objective of this improved resilience and safety of households affected by the 2015 earthquake. However, 34% of respondents feel their coping capacity has diminished since the earthquake. These people feel more vulnerable because they are not living in a safe shelter (56%), they have no savings (51%), they are burdened by heavy debt (39%) and their livelihood options are reduced (37%). For these people, there is a significant risk that the one size fits all approach of the reconstruction process, with all its pressure and tight deadlines, is actually having the opposite of its intended effect, by making them worse off than they were before the earthquake.

Milijuli Nepali, BBC Media Action, Episode 1044: this is a studio based interview with Urusha Shrestha who is an engineer. During the interview, Ms. Shrestha highlights the proper use of cement, the differences between types of cement, the proportions of cement to be used for pouring floors, process of framing, different types of sand and their uses, and the importance of curing and how to do it. Ms. Shrestha also answers questions from local people about cement, soil, and curing.

Baliyo Ghar TV, Episodes 119: this week the programme shares reconstruction stories from villages in Okhaldhunga and Nuwakot – the story of 2 villages: similarities and differences in reconstruction practices, technical issues, compliance, and other issues! The programme airs on News24 TV on Wed @8:00AM and Avenues TV on Sat @8:30AM with twice repeats from each for a week.



बलियो घर
BALIYO GHAR

पुनर्निर्माणमा
नुवाकोट र ओखलढुङ्गाका दुई गाउँ

भाग - ११९





Santipur

Sunday 7:00 PM, Monday 02:30 AM
& 01:30 PM



news 24

Wednesday 8:00 AM, 2:00 PM
& Thursday 04:30 AM



रेडियो नेपाल

Saturday 8:30 AM
Sunday 04:30 AM & 03:00 PM

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